

Chapter 2

Worksheet

Instructions:

Please complete all activities in this worksheet. Write your answers in the spaces provided or on separate sheets if needed.

Worksheet 1: Media Influence and Algorithms

Part 1: Reflect on Media's Influence (Short Answer)

Media shapes how you see yourself and the world, often without you even noticing. Let's think about how it's hitting your life right now.

- **Body Image and Lifestyle Impact** Think about a time you felt pressured by media (like Instagram, TikTok, or TV shows) to look or act a certain way. Maybe it was about your body, clothes, or even food trends. Describe the situation below:
 - What did you see or hear in the media? (e.g., a "perfect" beach body post or a trendy fit)
 - How did it make you feel about yourself? (e.g., insecure, motivated, left out)
 - Did you change anything about yourself because of it? (e.g., tried a diet, bought something)

Answer: _____

- **Peer Pressure from Trends** Recall a viral challenge or influencer trend you've seen (like a TikTok dance or product hype). Did you feel pressured to join in? Why or why not?
 - Name the trend or challenge (e.g., "Renegade" dance, a brand collab).
 - Did you participate? If yes, what pushed you to do it? If no, what held you back?
 - How did your friends or online community react to it?

Answer: _____

Part 2: Decode the Algorithms (Scenario-Based Questions)

Algorithms control what you see online, often trapping you in echo chambers or pushing manipulative content. Let's break down how they work in your digital life.

- **Echo Chamber Exploration** Imagine your TikTok feed is 90% basketball highlights and sneaker drops because you've liked a bunch of those vids. You rarely see anything about art, cooking, or politics.
 - How does this create an "echo chamber" or "filter bubble" for you?
Answer: _____
 - What's one way you could break out of this bubble to see more diverse content? (e.g., search a new topic, like different stuff) **Answer:** _____
- **Manipulation Check** Have you ever been sucked into watching "clickbait" content—like a vid with a thumbnail screaming "YOU WON'T BELIEVE THIS!"—only to realize it wasted your time? Describe one example.
 - What was the content, and why did you click on it?

- How did it make you feel after watching? (e.g., annoyed, hooked for more)
- How do algorithms use this kind of content to keep teens scrolling?

Answer: _____

Part 3: Wrap-Up Reflection (Personal Takeaway)

- **Your Media Smarts Glow-Up** After working through this worksheet, what's one big lesson you've learned about media influence or algorithms? How will you use this to "own your scroll" going forward? (e.g., question posts more, avoid clickbait, diversify your feed)

Answer: _____

Part 4: Creative Challenge – Design Your Own Algorithm-Busting Plan

Instead of just falling into the algorithm trap, let's flip the script! Imagine you're in charge of redesigning how your social media feed works to avoid echo chambers and manipulative content. Create a mini-plan to make your online experience more balanced and less "addictive."

- What's one rule you'd set for your feed to show more diverse content? (e.g., mix in random topics weekly)

Answer: _____

- How would you limit clickbait or emotionally charged content from taking over your screen time? (e.g., hide thumbnails with "SHOCKING!" vibes) **Answer:** _____

- What's one fun way you'd encourage yourself to explore new interests online? (e.g., a "try something new" challenge with friends) **Answer:** _____

Worksheet 2: Recognizing Bias in Media Content

Part 1: Spot the Bias (Analysis Activity)

Bias is everywhere in media, tilting stories to push an agenda. Let's practice sniffing it out with real-world examples you might see in your feed.

- **Headline Hunt** Below are two headlines about the same event—a student walkout for climate change. Read them and answer the questions.

- Headline A: "Reckless Teens Disrupt School with Unauthorized Protest!"
- Headline B: "Inspiring Young Activists Demand Action on Climate Crisis!" a) Which headline shows a negative bias against the students? How can you tell?

Answer: _____

- b) Which headline shows a positive bias toward the students? What words give it away? **Answer:** _____

- c) How might each headline shape a teen's opinion about the walkout if they didn't dig deeper? **Answer:** _____

- **Ad Analysis** Think of a recent ad or sponsored post you saw (e.g., a skincare product, clothing brand, or game on Insta/TikTok). Answer the following:

- What was the product, and how was it shown? (e.g., "perfect" results, cool vibe)
- What did the ad leave out? (e.g., price, side effects, realistic results)
- How might this be an example of commercial bias targeting teens like you?

Answer: _____

Part 2: Activity: Bias Hunt (Research and Analysis)

Bias often shows up when different sources cover the same topic in different ways. For this activity, you'll analyze two articles or posts on the same topic to spot signs of bias. Use your phone or computer if needed to find examples, or work with provided materials from your teacher.

- **Bias Hunt** Step 1: Choose a current topic or event that interests you (e.g., a new video game release, a school policy change, a celebrity controversy, or a social issue like climate change). Step 2: Find two different articles, posts, or videos about this topic from different sources (e.g., news outlets, influencers, or social media accounts). Step 3: Analyze them for bias using the questions below.

- **Topic Chosen:** _____
- **Source 1 (Title/Platform/Creator):** _____
 - What's the main message or angle of this piece?
Answer: _____
 - What words, tone, or visuals show bias (e.g., emotional language, one-sided facts)?
Answer: _____
 - What's missing or downplayed that might balance the story?
Answer: _____
- **Source 2 (Title/Platform/Creator):** _____
 - What's the main message or angle of this piece?
Answer: _____
 - What words, tone, or visuals show bias (e.g., emotional language, one-sided facts)?
Answer: _____
 - What's missing or downplayed that might balance the story?
Answer: _____
- **Comparison:** How do the two sources differ in their portrayal of the topic? Which seems more balanced, and why? **Answer:** _____

Part 3: Critical Thinking Challenge (Solo or Group Activity)

- **Media Detective Challenge** Pick one piece of media you've seen recently—it could be a news post, influencer vid, or ad on any platform. Analyze it for influence and bias using the questions below. (If working in a group, discuss and compare your findings!)
- What's the media piece? (Describe it briefly—platform, topic, creator if known)
Answer: _____
- Who made it, and what might their goal be? (e.g., to inform, sell, entertain, persuade)
Answer: _____
- Does it show any bias? (e.g., political, cultural, commercial—explain how)
Answer: _____
- How might it influence a teen like you? (e.g., pressure to act, buy, or think a certain way)
Answer: _____
- What's one question you'd ask to dig deeper into its truth or agenda?
Answer: _____

Part 4: Fun Debate Prep – Bias Battle

Let's make spotting bias interactive! Imagine you're preparing for a mini-debate with your squad about a trending topic (like "Should schools ban phones?" or "Are influencers good role models?"). Pick a side and brainstorm how media bias might shape opinions on this topic.

- **Topic Chosen:** _____
- What's one way media might show bias FOR your side? (e.g., positive headlines, emotional stories)
Answer: _____
- What's one way media might show bias AGAINST your side? (e.g., negative framing, ignoring facts)
Answer: _____

- How can you prepare to counter biased arguments with facts or different perspectives in a debate?

Answer: _____